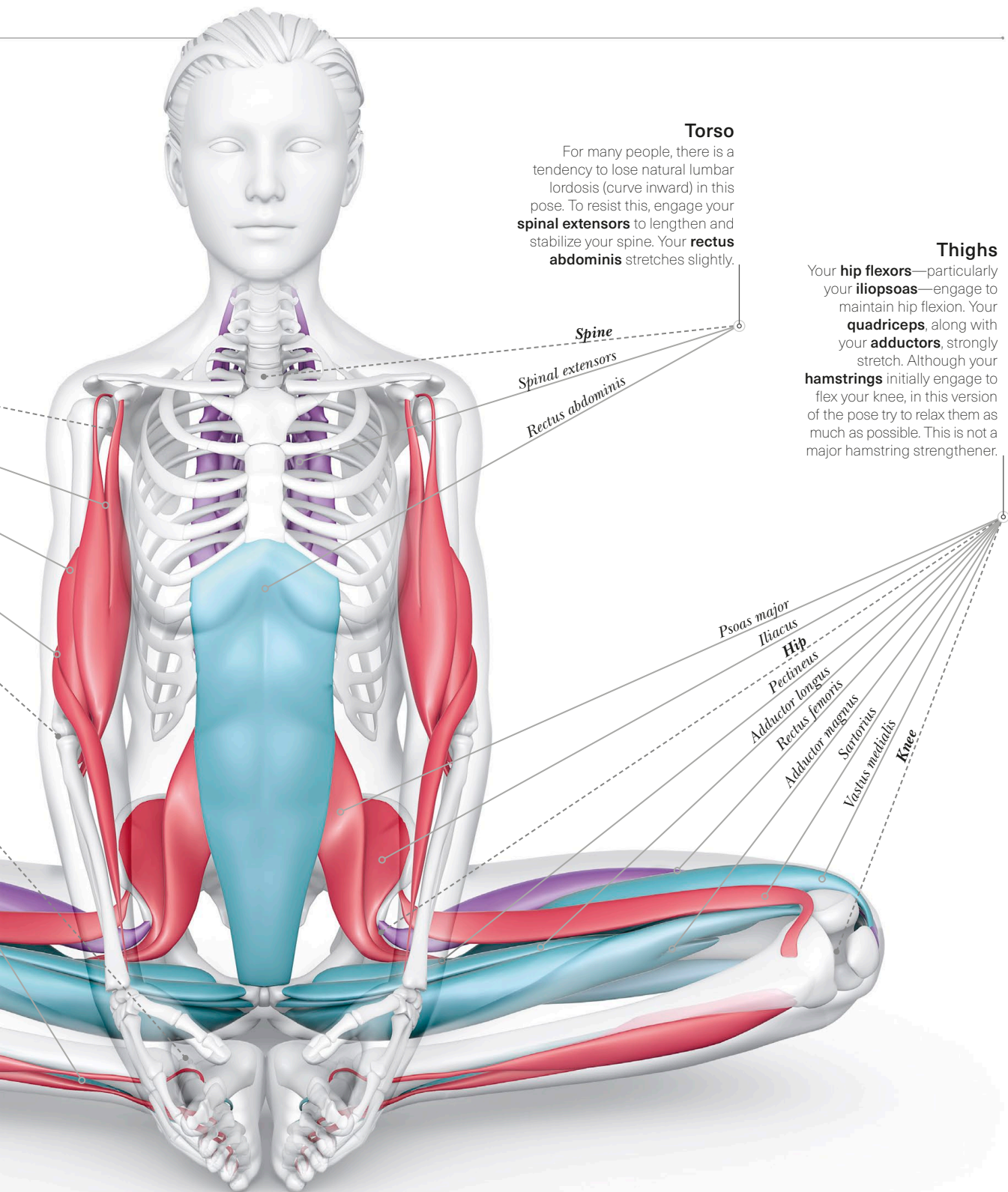




Torso

For many people, there is a tendency to lose natural lumbar lordosis (curve inward) in this pose. To resist this, engage your **spinal extensors** to lengthen and stabilize your spine. Your **rectus abdominis** stretches slightly.

Thighs

Your **hip flexors**—particularly your **iliopsoas**—engage to maintain hip flexion. Your **quadriceps**, along with your **adductors**, strongly stretch. Although your **hamstrings** initially engage to flex your knee, in this version of the pose try to relax them as much as possible. This is not a major hamstring strengthener.

Psoas major
Iliacus

Hip

Pectineus
Adductor longus

Rectus femoris
Adductor magnus

Sartorius
Vastus medialis

Knee